

FULL-DAY EMERGENCY SUB PLANS
KINDERGARTEN • VOLUME 2

THREE WHOLE DAYS

3
FULL DAYS

Ready-to-go kindergarten plans for those
last-minute cover days — **just print and teach.**

Built around a read-aloud,
for children who cannot read yet.



FULL DAY



READ-ALOUD



PICTURE-LED

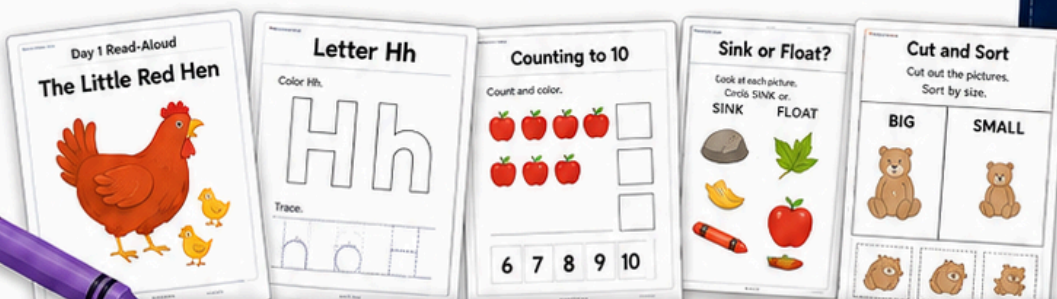


NO PREP

- ✓ Three complete school days, arrival to dismissal
- ✓ A read-aloud story every day, printed in full for the sub
- ✓ Letters, writing, math and science every day
- ✓ Every student page is picture-led, with one task on it
- ✓ Tracing rails, drawing space and cut-and-sort tasks

★ Perfect for busy
teachers and
last-minute subs

Everything you need
to walk in and teach
with confidence.



READING

Read-aloud stories
build comprehension
and vocabulary.



LETTERS

Letter recognition,
writing and phonics
every day.



MATH

Counting, numbers
and simple concepts
made visual.



SCIENCE

Hands-on thinking
and real-world
exploration.



DIGITAL VECTOR



Kindergarten



62 pages



digitalvector.com.au

How This Pack Works

START HERE

This is Volume 2. All three days are new, and nothing repeats from Volume 1. Most sub plans hand a substitute a worksheet. In kindergarten that fails before the worksheet reaches the table, because the children cannot read the instructions, cannot work alone, and have not got the pencil control the sheet assumes.

This pack is built the way a kindergarten day actually runs. A read-aloud on the carpet. Blocks of fifteen to twenty minutes. A movement break between almost all of them. And student pages that carry one task each, told in pictures.

What is different about a kindergarten pack

WHY IT MATTERS	
The adult talks constantly	Eight pages a day are for the substitute and eight are for the children. That is the correct way round at this age.
One task per page	Never two. A kindergarten child who finishes half a page has done the whole task, not half of it.
Pictures, not instructions	Every student page can be understood by a child who cannot read a word, because the pictures say what to do.
Tracing before writing	Rails with a dashed midline, letters at forty points, and a name line on every morning page.
Cut and sort, not fill in	The afternoon task is physical. Scissors and glue hold attention that a pencil will not.

SIXTEEN PAGES PER DAY. EIGHT TO COPY, EIGHT TO KEEP.

Copy each day as one stapled packet and hand it out in the morning.

The substitute keeps the Day at a Glance page, the carpet script, the read-aloud story, the three teaching scripts and the What to Look For page.

Will a substitute cope with this?

That is the question the pack is built to answer. Every block the substitute leads has the words to say printed out. The read-aloud has the whole story and the questions. The letter, math and afternoon blocks each have a script that says what to say, what to hold up, and what to do when a child cannot do it. There is a page on holding a kindergarten class you have never met, and a bank of things to do when a gap opens up. None of it assumes early years training.



Substitute Quick Start

FOR THE SUBSTITUTE

If you have five minutes before the children arrive, read this page and nothing else.

IN THE FIRST FIVE MINUTES

1. Find the Day at a Glance page. Put it on the desk and leave it.
2. Check the packets are copied. If not, copy the Morning Work page first and the rest while they work.
3. Write your name on the board and draw a small picture next to it. They will use the picture, not the name.
4. Read the carpet script. Do not improvise the first minute.
5. Skim the story so you are not seeing it for the first time in front of them.

The shape of every day in this pack

ROUGHLY	WHAT HAPPENS
Arrival	Morning work at tables. Tracing and coloring. You take attendance while they work.
Carpet	Ten minutes. Introduce yourself, teach the quiet signal, say what happens before recess.
Read aloud	Fifteen minutes on the carpet, then talking, then drawing at tables.
Morning blocks	Letters, then writing, then math. A movement break between each one.
Afternoon	Rest time, then the science block read aloud together, then cut and sort.
Last ten minutes	The How Was Today? sheet, then pack up.

THREE THINGS THAT MATTER MORE THAN THE LESSONS

Say what is next before every change. "When I count to five we are putting pencils down." They are not being difficult at transitions. They do not know what is coming.

Ask them to show you the routines. Where they line up, how they hand things in, who sits where. They know, they love telling you, and it makes them your allies.

Praise out loud, correct quietly. Naming a child who is doing the right thing moves a whole room.



The Three Days

THE THREE DAYS

Each day is completely independent. Leave them in any order. No day assumes anything from another.

DAY	STORY	LETTER	MATH	AFTERNOON
4	Bella's Big Boots	Bb	Patterns	Weather and What We Wear
5	The Frog Who Could Not Sit Still	Ff	Big and Small	Our Eyes and Our Ears
6	Pip Plants a Pumpkin	Pp	More and Fewer	Where Our Food Comes From

The read-aloud stories

DAY	THE STORY	WHAT IT IS REALLY ABOUT
4	Bella's Big Boots	A girl loves her boots so much she wears them everywhere, until the one morning they are exactly the wrong thing.
5	The Frog Who Could Not Sit Still	A frog cannot stop hopping long enough to hear anything, until he finds the one thing worth being still for.
6	Pip Plants a Pumpkin	One seed, one summer, and a pumpkin so big it takes two people and a wheelbarrow to move it.

WHICH DAY SHOULD I LEAVE?

A class you do not know at all: Day 1. The story is the gentlest and the counting only goes to five.

You want work you can look at when you return: Day 3. The counting page shows you instantly who has one to one correspondence.

A restless group, or a Friday: Day 2. The shape hunt gets them up and moving with a purpose.

A NOTE ON THE READ-ALOUD

The full text of each story is printed on the substitute page, with three marked places to stop and ask a question. At this age the story is the biggest teaching block of the morning, not a warm-up.

Read it slowly. Take two or three answers at each stop and then carry on, however many hands are still up.

Class Information

TEACHER • FILL THIS IN ONCE AT THE START OF THE YEAR

Complete this once and it works for every absence after. A kindergarten substitute needs far more of this than an older grade does.

THE BASICS

My name and grade

Room number

Teach this day

Day ____ or any day from the index

Teacher next door

Office extension

Teaching assistant

THE DAY

Bell times

Recess and lunch

Rest time

How long, and do they lie down?

Bathroom routine

Alone, in pairs, or as a class?

Where the class lines up

Carpet spots

THE CHILDREN

Collected by an adult?

Who, and any custody notes

Medical, allergies, medication

Toileting and spare clothes

Children who find change hard

Children who can help you

Holding a Kindergarten Class

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

FIVE YEAR OLDS ARE NOT TESTING YOU ON PURPOSE

They are finding out what the rules are with a new adult, which is a sensible thing for a small person to do. Being warm and completely predictable settles a room faster than being strict.

Say this instead of that

INSTEAD OF	TRY
"Be quiet!"	"Show me listening ears." Then wait. Do not repeat it.
"Sit down."	"Bottoms on the carpet, hands in your lap, eyes on me." Say all three parts.
"Who did that?"	"I am waiting for one more person." Never name a child in front of the class.
"Stop it."	"That is not a safe choice. Show me a safe choice." Then praise whoever does.
"Hurry up."	"I am counting to ten and then we are going." Then count. Out loud. Slowly.
"You should know this."	"Let me show you again." They might genuinely not know, and being told off stops them asking.

Six moves that work in any kindergarten room

- Teach a clap-back signal in the first ten minutes. You clap, they clap it back. Practice it once while everyone is calm.
- Count down instead of asking twice. "Pencils down in five, four, three." It moves a room faster than any instruction.
- Narrate what is going right. "Table two is ready." The rest copy within seconds and nobody has been told off.
- Give the busiest child a job. Handing out packets, holding the door, line leader. Redirection, not reward.
- Get them up every fifteen minutes. Fidgeting at this age is a signal, not misbehavior.
- Sit down on the carpet with them for the story. Standing over a group of five year olds makes them wriggle.

WHEN SOMETHING GOES PROPERLY WRONG

If a child is hurt, distressed, or a situation is beyond a normal classroom problem, send two children to the office or the teacher next door. Do not leave the class, and do not try to handle it alone because you want to seem capable.

Crying is common at this age and usually passes. Kneel down to their height, say what happens next, and give it two minutes before deciding it is serious.

What Is on Every Page

EVERY PAGE IN THIS PACK

Eight pages per day are copied for the children. Eight are kept by the substitute, because at this age the adult needs more paper than the class does.

PAGE	WHAT IT IS	CONTENTS
1-7	Getting started	Cover, how the pack works, quick start, the three days, class information, holding a kindergarten class, this page
8-15	Day 4 scripts	Day at a Glance, carpet script, the full story, and three teaching scripts. Substitute keeps these.
16-23	Day 4 student pages	Morning work, after the story, Bb, writing, two math pages, the cut and sort, and How Was Today? Eight pages to copy.
24-31	Day 5 scripts	Day at a Glance, carpet script, the full story, and three teaching scripts. Substitute keeps these.
32-39	Day 5 student pages	Morning work, after the story, Ff, writing, two math pages, the cut and sort, and How Was Today? Eight pages to copy.
40-47	Day 6 scripts	Day at a Glance, carpet script, the full story, and three teaching scripts. Substitute keeps these.
48-55	Day 6 student pages	Morning work, after the story, Pp, writing, two math pages, the cut and sort, and How Was Today? Eight pages to copy.
56-60	The filler banks	Time fillers, brain breaks, wet weather games, a choosing time menu and the substitute note back
61-62	Reference	Standards alignment, terms of use and credits

THE FASTEST WAY TO USE THIS PACK

Photocopy the eight student pages for one day as a single stapled packet. Put the eight substitute pages on the desk in order. That is the whole preparation.

Day 4 at a Glance

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE ON YOUR DESK

THE WHOLE DAY, IN ONE TABLE

Times are a guide. Your school bells win. The Page column tells you which sheet the children need in front of them.

Blocks are short on purpose. A five year old concentrates for about five to ten minutes on one thing. Nothing here runs past twenty, and there is a movement break between almost all of them.

TIME	BLOCK	WHAT HAPPENS	PAGE
8:30	Arrival	Children come in and start Morning Work. Take attendance while they trace.	p. 16
8:45	Carpet time	Read the script. Teach your quiet signal now.	keep
9:00	Read aloud	The story, on the carpet. Stop at the orange boxes.	keep
9:20	Talk about it	Turn and talk, then the drawing page at desks.	p. 17
9:40	Movement break	Two minutes. Use the Brain Breaks page.	back
9:50	Letters	Teach the sound, then the tracing page.	p. 18
10:15	Recess	Ask a child where the class lines up.	—
10:40	Writing	Draw first, then one word underneath.	p. 19
11:05	Break	Two minutes. They will need it.	back
11:15	Math	Teaching script together, then the two pages.	p. 20
11:55	Lunch	Line them up five minutes early.	—
12:45	Rest time	Books, heads down, or the quiet bank.	back
1:10	Afternoon	Read the science page aloud, then the cut and sort.	p. 22
1:50	Choosing time	If there is no special, use the Filler Bank.	back
2:30	Closing	How Was Today? sheet, then pack up.	p. 23
2:50	Dismissal	Stack all work with the closing sheets on top.	—

IF YOU ARE RUNNING BEHIND

Cut choosing time and the second math page first. Never cut the movement breaks or the closing sheet.

THE SINGLE MOST USEFUL THING YOU CAN DO

Say what is happening next, out loud, before every change. They are not being difficult at transitions. They genuinely do not know what is coming.

Carpet Time and First Moves

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

THE FIRST FIFTEEN MINUTES DECIDE THE DAY

You are a stranger and they will check what the rules are with you. Being warm and completely predictable is worth more than being strict.

On the carpet, ten minutes

SAY THIS TO START

Good morning everybody. My name is on the board, and I have drawn a little picture next to it so you can find it.

Your teacher is away today and she left me a plan for the whole day, so I know exactly what we are doing.

First, my quiet signal. I clap like this, and you clap it back. Let us practice. Lovely.

This morning we have a story about a girl and her red boots, some letters, and some patterns. This afternoon we find out about the weather and what we wear.

You will have to help me with your names.

Then, in this order

WHAT YOU DO

- 1 Write your name on the board and draw a small picture beside it. They will remember the picture.
- 2 Teach the clap-back signal. Practice it twice now, while everyone is calm.
- 3 Read the script above. Do not improvise the first minute.
- 4 Ask: what does this class always do at carpet time? Take two answers only.
- 5 Say what happens before recess, in order, on your fingers.
- 6 Start the story while they are still settled.

YOUR QUIET SIGNAL

Teach one in the first ten minutes and use it all day. A clap-back pattern works everywhere: you clap a short rhythm, they clap it back. Practice it once while everyone is calm and it will work when they are not.

Read Aloud: Bella's Big Boots

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD. KEEP THIS PAGE.

HOW TO READ IT

Children sit on the carpet. Read slowly. The orange boxes are places to stop and ask the question printed in them. Take two or three answers, then carry on. Do not stop anywhere else, however many hands go up.

Bella's Big Boots

Read-aloud story

Bella had red boots, and Bella loved them.

She wore them to the shops. She wore them to Grandma's. She wore them in the garden, and once, when nobody was looking, she wore them in the bath.

STOP AND ASK

Where do you think Bella will wear her boots?

On Monday it rained, and the boots were perfect. Bella jumped in every puddle on the way to school.

On Tuesday it rained again. Perfect again.

On Wednesday it rained so hard that the whole playground turned into one enormous puddle, and Bella was the only child who did not have to walk around it.

STOP AND ASK

What do you think is going to go wrong?

On Thursday, Bella got up, and she put on her boots, and she did not look out of the window even once.

It was sports day.

It was sunny and hot and dry, and there was a running race, and everybody else had sneakers.

Bella ran the whole race in her big red boots. Clomp. Clomp. Clomp.

She came last. She did not mind very much, because everybody cheered for the boots.

But on Friday, before she got dressed, Bella went and looked out of the window first.

STOP AND ASK

What should Bella have looked at first?



Talking About the Story

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

Five minutes on the carpet, then send them to tables for the drawing page. Kindergarten comprehension is spoken, not written, so this is where you find out whether the story landed.

Turn and talk, twice

SAY THIS

Turn to the person next to you. Tell them the part you liked best. I will count to twenty and then I want to hear two of them.

Now tell them one thing that happened at the beginning, and one thing that happened at the end.

What to listen for

DOING WELL	NOT YET
Retells one thing that actually happened in the story	Retells a different story, or tells you their own news
Uses a character name	Says "the one" or "him" for everybody
Answers the question that was asked	Answers a question nobody asked, which is very normal at five

The answers you are listening for

WHAT A GOOD ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE	
Question 1	Open. Take three places. Somewhere silly is fine and usually comes first.
Question 2	Look for the idea that the boots will be wrong for something. Nobody needs to guess sports day.
Question 3	The window, or the weather. That is the whole story and it sets up the afternoon block.

THEN SEND THEM TO TABLES

The drawing page comes next. Say it before you move: "Draw the part you liked best. One picture. You do not have to write anything."

A child who draws something not in the story has still listened. Ask them about it before you decide otherwise.

Teaching Bb

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD

SAY THIS

Today our sound is Bb. Watch my mouth. b.

Now you. b. Again, longer. b.

Put your hand in front of your mouth and say it again. Can you feel it?

Now I am going to say some words. Put your thumb up if the word starts with b.

Then, in this order

WHAT YOU DO

- 1 Write the letter big on the board, capital and small. Say the sound each time, not the letter name.
- 2 Say the words on the student page out loud, one at a time. Thumbs up or thumbs down.
- 3 Hand out the page. Point at the tracing rail and trace one in the air together first.
- 4 They trace, then circle the pictures. Say the picture names out loud as they work, because some will not know them.

THE SOUND, NOT THE NAME

Say b, not the letter name. At this age the sound is what lets them read; the name comes later and gets in the way now.

If a child is stuck

THEY CANNOT	DO THIS
Hear the sound	Say the word slowly and stretch the first sound. Stretch it far longer than feels sensible.
Form the letter	Trace it on their back with your finger, then let them trace it on the table, then on paper.
Name the picture	Tell them. It is a vocabulary gap, not a phonics one, and guessing wastes the block.



Teaching Patterns

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD

SAY THIS

Clap, tap, clap, tap. Do it with me. Clap, tap, clap, tap.

What comes next? Say it, do not put your hand up.

That is a pattern. A pattern is something that happens again and again in the same order.

Now look at the board. Circle, square, circle, square. What comes next?

The thing you are actually teaching

SAY IT OUT LOUD BEFORE YOU DRAW IT

A five year old finds the pattern with their voice long before their eyes. Every time, chant the pattern from the beginning out loud, then say what comes next. A child who cannot see it can almost always hear it.

What good looks like

DOING WELL	NOT YET
Chants the pattern from the start to work out what is next	Guesses at the gap without going back to the beginning
Copies a pattern and keeps it going	Copies the shapes but loses the order after two
Makes up a pattern of their own	Draws a row of the same shape, which is a fine place to start

TWO PAGES, IN ORDER

The first math page is done together, out loud. The second is theirs to do at the table. If the block is running long, stop after the first page. Half of it done properly is worth more than both rushed.

Science: Weather and What We Wear

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD TOGETHER

Read one numbered part at a time. Ask the question at the end of each one before you move on. This is a talking block, not a writing block.

1. The weather changes all the time, and it changes what we need to wear. That is the only reason anybody owns a raincoat.

Ask: what is the weather doing right now? Look out of the window.

2. When it rains we want things that keep the water off. A coat with a hood. An umbrella. Boots, like Bella has.

Ask: why do you think boots are good in the rain?

3. When it is sunny and hot we want the opposite. Thin clothes, a hat, and something to drink.

Ask: what do you wear on a really hot day?

4. Nobody can tell exactly what the weather will do. But you can look out of the window before you get dressed, which is more than Bella did on Thursday.

Ask: what should Bella have done first?

THEN THE CUT AND SORT

Hand out the sorting page. Cut first, all of them, before anybody glues anything. Then sort. Then glue.

Sunny: the sun and the hat. Rainy: the umbrella and the rain cloud. A child who puts the hat in the rain box and explains it is right too, and worth saying out loud.

What to Look For

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

Kindergarten work does not mark like older work. Most of these pages have no right answer, so this page tells you what to look at instead, and what to write on the note back.

The pages with actual answers

PAGE	ANSWER
Letters: Bb	Circle: boot, ball, bird, bed. Not circled: cat, sun, moon, tree.
Math: shapes	Row one: circle. Row two: star. Row three: sun. Accept any drawing that is recognisably the right item, however wobbly.
Afternoon sort	Sunny: the sun and the hat. Rainy: the umbrella and the rain cloud. A child who puts the hat in the rain box and explains it is right too, and worth saying out loud.

The pages with no right answer

PAGE	WHAT YOU ARE LOOKING AT
Morning work	Did they find their name line and have a go? Tracing quality is not the point on a day with a stranger in the room.
After the story	Does the picture come from the story? Ask them about it before deciding it does not.
Writing	One letter is a success. The initial sound is a big success. A whole word is a bonus, not the target.
How Was Today?	The most useful page in the pile. Read these first and leave them on top.

DO NOT CORRECT THE LETTER FORMATION

Backwards letters are developmentally normal at five and stay normal for a while yet. Correcting them in front of a substitute teaches a child that writing is dangerous. Leave it for the class teacher.

IF A CHILD PRODUCED NOTHING AT ALL

Do not push. Write their name on the sheet, note one line on the substitute page at the back, and move on. A child who freezes with a stranger in the room is telling you something, and it is not about the task.

Morning Work

Name: _____

1 Write your name at the top.

2 Trace the words. Say each one out loud.

3 Color the picture.

1. Trace and say

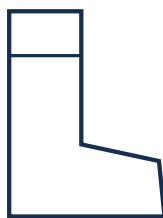
big

bat

bed

2. Color me

COLOR THE PICTURE FROM TODAY'S STORY



After the Story

1 Draw the part you liked best.

2 Tell somebody about your picture.

DRAW YOUR FAVORITE PART



My picture

TALK ABOUT IT

Tell the person next to you what is happening in your picture.

Letter of the Day: Bb

1 Trace the letters.

2 Circle the pictures that start with the sound.

B

b

B

b

B

b

Circle the ones that start with b



boot



cat



ball



sun



bird



moon



bed



tree

FINISHED?

Find one more thing in this room that starts with b. Draw it on the back of your sheet.

Draw and Label

1 Draw one thing from the story.

2 Write the first letter underneath.

YOUR PICTURE



What did you draw?

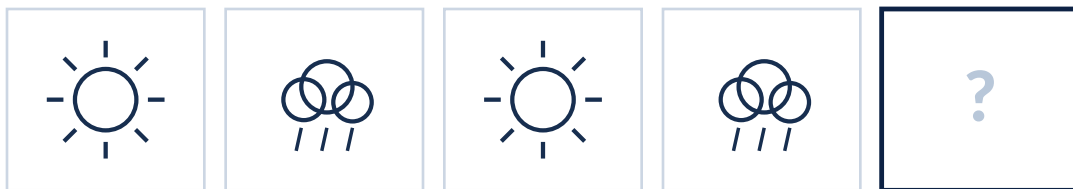
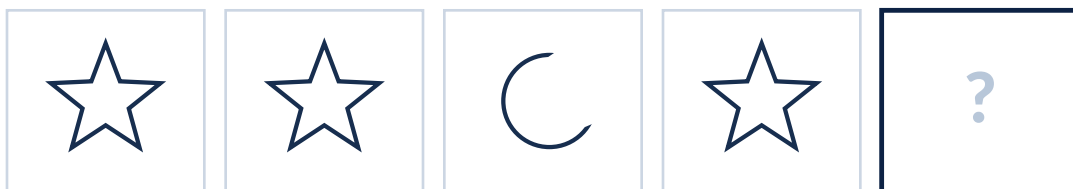
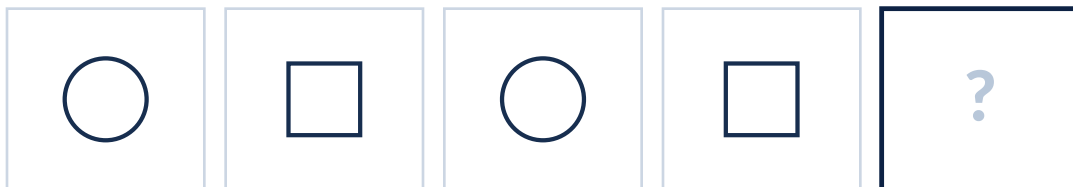
FOR THE SUBSTITUTE

One letter is a success here. If a child writes the first sound of their word, that is exactly where kindergarten writing should be. Do not ask for more, and do not correct what they do write.

Patterns

1 Say the pattern out loud.

2 Draw what comes next in the dark box.



Your Turn

1 Finish the pattern.

2 Then make one of your own.



Now make your own pattern



Weather and What We Wear: Cut and Sort

1 Cut out the four pictures at the bottom.

2 Put each one in the right box.

3 Glue them down when you are sure.

A SUNNY DAY

A RAINY DAY



sun



hat



umbrella



cloud

FINISHED?

Draw one more thing that would go in either box.

How Was Today?

1 Color the face that shows how today felt.

2 Draw one thing you did today.



Great day



Good day



Tricky day

One thing I did today

DRAW IT HERE



My name

Day 5 at a Glance

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE ON YOUR DESK

THE WHOLE DAY, IN ONE TABLE

Times are a guide. Your school bells win. The Page column tells you which sheet the children need in front of them.

Blocks are short on purpose. A five year old concentrates for about five to ten minutes on one thing. Nothing here runs past twenty, and there is a movement break between almost all of them.

TIME	BLOCK	WHAT HAPPENS	PAGE
8:30	Arrival	Children come in and start Morning Work. Take attendance while they trace.	p. 32
8:45	Carpet time	Read the script. Teach your quiet signal now.	keep
9:00	Read aloud	The story, on the carpet. Stop at the orange boxes.	keep
9:20	Talk about it	Turn and talk, then the drawing page at desks.	p. 33
9:40	Movement break	Two minutes. Use the Brain Breaks page.	back
9:50	Letters	Teach the sound, then the tracing page.	p. 34
10:15	Recess	Ask a child where the class lines up.	—
10:40	Writing	Draw first, then one word underneath.	p. 35
11:05	Break	Two minutes. They will need it.	back
11:15	Math	Teaching script together, then the two pages.	p. 36
11:55	Lunch	Line them up five minutes early.	—
12:45	Rest time	Books, heads down, or the quiet bank.	back
1:10	Afternoon	Read the science page aloud, then the cut and sort.	p. 38
1:50	Choosing time	If there is no special, use the Filler Bank.	back
2:30	Closing	How Was Today? sheet, then pack up.	p. 39
2:50	Dismissal	Stack all work with the closing sheets on top.	—

IF YOU ARE RUNNING BEHIND

Cut choosing time and the second math page first. Never cut the movement breaks or the closing sheet.

THE SINGLE MOST USEFUL THING YOU CAN DO

Say what is happening next, out loud, before every change. They are not being difficult at transitions. They genuinely do not know what is coming.

Carpet Time and First Moves

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

THE FIRST FIFTEEN MINUTES DECIDE THE DAY

You are a stranger and they will check what the rules are with you. Being warm and completely predictable is worth more than being strict.

On the carpet, ten minutes

SAY THIS TO START

Good morning everybody. My name is on the board, and I have drawn a little picture next to it so you can find it.

Your teacher is away today and she left me a plan for the whole day, so I know exactly what we are doing.

First, my quiet signal. I clap like this, and you clap it back. Let us practice. Lovely.

This morning we have a story about a frog who cannot sit still, some letters, and some big and small. This afternoon we find out about our eyes and our ears.

You will have to help me with your names.

Then, in this order

WHAT YOU DO

- 1 Write your name on the board and draw a small picture beside it. They will remember the picture.
- 2 Teach the clap-back signal. Practice it twice now, while everyone is calm.
- 3 Read the script above. Do not improvise the first minute.
- 4 Ask: what does this class always do at carpet time? Take two answers only.
- 5 Say what happens before recess, in order, on your fingers.
- 6 Start the story while they are still settled.

YOUR QUIET SIGNAL

Teach one in the first ten minutes and use it all day. A clap-back pattern works everywhere: you clap a short rhythm, they clap it back. Practice it once while everyone is calm and it will work when they are not.

Read Aloud: The Frog Who Could Not Sit Still

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD. KEEP THIS PAGE.

HOW TO READ IT

Children sit on the carpet. Read slowly. The orange boxes are places to stop and ask the question printed in them. Take two or three answers, then carry on. Do not stop anywhere else, however many hands go up.

The Frog Who Could Not Sit Still

Read-aloud story

Fred was a frog, and Fred could not sit still.

He hopped while he was eating. He hopped while he was listening. He once hopped so much during a conversation that he ended up on the other side of the pond and had to hop all the way back.

STOP AND ASK

Why do you think Fred cannot sit still?

"Fred," said his mother, "sit still for one minute."

Fred sat still for about four seconds, which for Fred was a record.

"There is a thing in this pond," she said, "that you have never once heard, because you have never once been quiet."

Fred wanted to know what it was. So he tried.

He sat on a lily pad. He held on to his own feet, which helped. And he waited.

STOP AND ASK

What do you think he is missing?

First he heard nothing.

Then he heard the wind.

Then he heard a bird, far away, and a fish come up and go down again, and a beetle walking along a leaf right beside him, which was much louder than a beetle ought to be.

And then, underneath all of it, he heard the pond itself. A small, slow, bubbling sound, going on all the time, that had been there his whole life.

Fred sat still for eleven whole minutes.

Then he hopped off to tell everybody, at speed, because he was still Fred.

STOP AND ASK

What made Fred stop in the end?



Talking About the Story

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

Five minutes on the carpet, then send them to tables for the drawing page. Kindergarten comprehension is spoken, not written, so this is where you find out whether the story landed.

Turn and talk, twice

SAY THIS

Turn to the person next to you. Tell them the part you liked best. I will count to twenty and then I want to hear two of them.

Now tell them one thing that happened at the beginning, and one thing that happened at the end.

What to listen for

DOING WELL	NOT YET
Retells one thing that actually happened in the story	Retells a different story, or tells you their own news
Uses a character name	Says "the one" or "him" for everybody
Answers the question that was asked	Answers a question nobody asked, which is very normal at five

The answers you are listening for

WHAT A GOOD ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE	
Question 1	Open. Some children will say he is naughty. Steer gently towards he has too much energy.
Question 2	Open. Sounds, or the pond. Take three and move on.
Question 3	He wanted to know what the sound was. Wanting to know is what made him still, not being told off.

THEN SEND THEM TO TABLES

The drawing page comes next. Say it before you move: "Draw the part you liked best. One picture. You do not have to write anything."

A child who draws something not in the story has still listened. Ask them about it before you decide otherwise.

Teaching Ff

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD

SAY THIS

Today our sound is Ff. Watch my mouth. fff.

Now you. fff. Again, longer. fff.

Put your hand in front of your mouth and say it again. Can you feel it?

Now I am going to say some words. Put your thumb up if the word starts with fff.

Then, in this order

WHAT YOU DO

- 1 Write the letter big on the board, capital and small. Say the sound each time, not the letter name.
- 2 Say the words on the student page out loud, one at a time. Thumbs up or thumbs down.
- 3 Hand out the page. Point at the tracing rail and trace one in the air together first.
- 4 They trace, then circle the pictures. Say the picture names out loud as they work, because some will not know them.

THE SOUND, NOT THE NAME

Say fff, not the letter name. At this age the sound is what lets them read; the name comes later and gets in the way now.

If a child is stuck

THEY CANNOT	DO THIS
Hear the sound	Say the word slowly and stretch the first sound. Stretch it far longer than feels sensible.
Form the letter	Trace it on their back with your finger, then let them trace it on the table, then on paper.
Name the picture	Tell them. It is a vocabulary gap, not a phonics one, and guessing wastes the block.



Teaching Big and Small

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD

SAY THIS

Hold up your hands. Make them as big as you can. Now as small as you can.

I am going to say two things and you tell me which is bigger. A mouse or an elephant? A shoe or a house?

Now a harder one. Bigger is not always the same as longer.

Hold up a pencil and a book. Which is longer? Which is bigger? Let them argue about it for a moment.

The thing you are actually teaching

COMPARE TWO THINGS AT A TIME

Bigger and smaller only mean anything next to something else. Always put two things side by side. A child who says a thing is big without comparing it has not got the idea yet.

What good looks like

DOING WELL	NOT YET
Puts two things side by side before deciding	Decides from memory, without lining them up
Uses the words bigger and smaller , not just big	Says big for everything, including the smaller one
Can order three things from small to big	Manages two but loses the middle one

TWO PAGES, IN ORDER

The first math page is done together, out loud. The second is theirs to do at the table. If the block is running long, stop after the first page. Half of it done properly is worth more than both rushed.

Science: Our Eyes and Our Ears

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD TOGETHER

Read one numbered part at a time. Ask the question at the end of each one before you move on. This is a talking block, not a writing block.

1. You have five senses. Today we only need two of them. Your eyes, for seeing, and your ears, for hearing.

Ask: cover your eyes. What can you still tell about this room?

2. Your eyes only work when there is light. In the dark they cannot do anything at all, which is why you cannot read in bed with the light off.

Ask: what happens if you close your eyes and I move quietly?

3. Your ears work all the time, even when you are asleep. They do not have lids. That is why a loud noise wakes you up.

Ask: everybody be completely still. What can you hear right now?

4. Fred could not hear the pond because he never stopped moving. Being still is how you notice small things.

Ask: try it. Ten seconds of nobody moving. What did you hear?

THEN THE CUT AND SORT

Hand out the sorting page. Cut first, all of them, before anybody glues anything. Then sort. Then glue. Eyes: the star and the moon. Ears: the drum and the bell. A child who says you can see a drum too is completely right and has understood the lesson better than the sort has.

What to Look For

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

Kindergarten work does not mark like older work. Most of these pages have no right answer, so this page tells you what to look at instead, and what to write on the note back.

The pages with actual answers

PAGE	ANSWER
Letters: Ff	Circle: frog, fish, flower, feather. Not circled: cat, moon, ball, tree.
Math: shapes	Bigger: the house, the sun, the tree. On the second page any drawing that is clearly larger and clearly smaller is correct. Size, not neatness.
Afternoon sort	Eyes: the star and the moon. Ears: the drum and the bell. A child who says you can see a drum too is completely right and has understood the lesson better than the sort has.

The pages with no right answer

PAGE	WHAT YOU ARE LOOKING AT
Morning work	Did they find their name line and have a go? Tracing quality is not the point on a day with a stranger in the room.
After the story	Does the picture come from the story? Ask them about it before deciding it does not.
Writing	One letter is a success. The initial sound is a big success. A whole word is a bonus, not the target.
How Was Today?	The most useful page in the pile. Read these first and leave them on top.

DO NOT CORRECT THE LETTER FORMATION

Backwards letters are developmentally normal at five and stay normal for a while yet. Correcting them in front of a substitute teaches a child that writing is dangerous. Leave it for the class teacher.

IF A CHILD PRODUCED NOTHING AT ALL

Do not push. Write their name on the sheet, note one line on the substitute page at the back, and move on. A child who freezes with a stranger in the room is telling you something, and it is not about the task.

Morning Work

Name: _____

1 Write your name at the top.

2 Trace the words. Say each one out loud.

3 Color the picture.

1. Trace and say

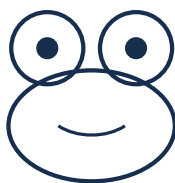
fun

fan

fit

2. Color me

COLOR THE PICTURE FROM TODAY'S STORY



After the Story

1 Draw the part you liked best.

2 Tell somebody about your picture.

DRAW YOUR FAVORITE PART



My picture

TALK ABOUT IT

Tell the person next to you what is happening in your picture.

Letter of the Day: Ff

1 Trace the letters.

2 Circle the pictures that start with the sound.

F f F f F f

Circle the ones that start with fff



frog



cat



fish



moon



flower



ball



feather



tree

FINISHED?

Find one more thing in this room that starts with fff. Draw it on the back of your sheet.

Draw and Label

1 Draw one thing from the story.

2 Write the first letter underneath.

YOUR PICTURE



What did you draw?

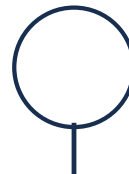
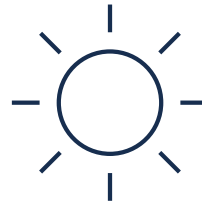
FOR THE SUBSTITUTE

One letter is a success here. If a child writes the first sound of their word, that is exactly where kindergarten writing should be. Do not ask for more, and do not correct what they do write.

Big and Small

1 Look at each pair.

2 Circle the one that is bigger.



Your Turn

1 Look at the picture on the left.

2 Draw a bigger one, then a smaller one.



BIGGER

SMALLER



BIGGER

SMALLER



BIGGER

SMALLER



Our Eyes and Our Ears: Cut and Sort

1 Cut out the four pictures at the bottom.

2 Put each one in the right box.

3 Glue them down when you are sure.

WE USE OUR EYES

WE USE OUR EARS



star



drum



bell



moon

FINISHED?

Draw one more thing that would go in either box.

How Was Today?

1 Color the face that shows how today felt.

2 Draw one thing you did today.



Great day



Good day



Tricky day

One thing I did today

DRAW IT HERE



My name

Day 6 at a Glance

SUBSTITUTE · KEEP THIS PAGE ON YOUR DESK

THE WHOLE DAY, IN ONE TABLE

Times are a guide. Your school bells win. The Page column tells you which sheet the children need in front of them.

Blocks are short on purpose. A five year old concentrates for about five to ten minutes on one thing. Nothing here runs past twenty, and there is a movement break between almost all of them.

TIME	BLOCK	WHAT HAPPENS	PAGE
8:30	Arrival	Children come in and start Morning Work. Take attendance while they trace.	p. 48
8:45	Carpet time	Read the script. Teach your quiet signal now.	keep
9:00	Read aloud	The story, on the carpet. Stop at the orange boxes.	keep
9:20	Talk about it	Turn and talk, then the drawing page at desks.	p. 49
9:40	Movement break	Two minutes. Use the Brain Breaks page.	back
9:50	Letters	Teach the sound, then the tracing page.	p. 50
10:15	Recess	Ask a child where the class lines up.	—
10:40	Writing	Draw first, then one word underneath.	p. 51
11:05	Break	Two minutes. They will need it.	back
11:15	Math	Teaching script together, then the two pages.	p. 52
11:55	Lunch	Line them up five minutes early.	—
12:45	Rest time	Books, heads down, or the quiet bank.	back
1:10	Afternoon	Read the science page aloud, then the cut and sort.	p. 54
1:50	Choosing time	If there is no special, use the Filler Bank.	back
2:30	Closing	How Was Today? sheet, then pack up.	p. 55
2:50	Dismissal	Stack all work with the closing sheets on top.	—

IF YOU ARE RUNNING BEHIND

Cut choosing time and the second math page first. Never cut the movement breaks or the closing sheet.

THE SINGLE MOST USEFUL THING YOU CAN DO

Say what is happening next, out loud, before every change. They are not being difficult at transitions. They genuinely do not know what is coming.

Carpet Time and First Moves

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

THE FIRST FIFTEEN MINUTES DECIDE THE DAY

You are a stranger and they will check what the rules are with you. Being warm and completely predictable is worth more than being strict.

On the carpet, ten minutes

SAY THIS TO START

Good morning everybody. My name is on the board, and I have drawn a little picture next to it so you can find it.

Your teacher is away today and she left me a plan for the whole day, so I know exactly what we are doing.

First, my quiet signal. I clap like this, and you clap it back. Let us practice. Lovely.

This morning we have a story about one seed and a very big pumpkin, some letters, and some more and fewer.

This afternoon we find out where our food comes from.

You will have to help me with your names.

Then, in this order

WHAT YOU DO

- 1 Write your name on the board and draw a small picture beside it. They will remember the picture.
- 2 Teach the clap-back signal. Practice it twice now, while everyone is calm.
- 3 Read the script above. Do not improvise the first minute.
- 4 Ask: what does this class always do at carpet time? Take two answers only.
- 5 Say what happens before recess, in order, on your fingers.
- 6 Start the story while they are still settled.

YOUR QUIET SIGNAL

Teach one in the first ten minutes and use it all day. A clap-back pattern works everywhere: you clap a short rhythm, they clap it back. Practice it once while everyone is calm and it will work when they are not.

Read Aloud: Pip Plants a Pumpkin

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD. KEEP THIS PAGE.

HOW TO READ IT

Children sit on the carpet. Read slowly. The orange boxes are places to stop and ask the question printed in them. Take two or three answers, then carry on. Do not stop anywhere else, however many hands go up.

Pip Plants a Pumpkin

Read-aloud story

Pip found one seed in the bottom of a paper bag. It was flat and white and about the size of her thumbnail.

"That will be a pumpkin," said her grandad.

Pip did not believe him.

STOP AND ASK

How big do you think the pumpkin will get?

They dug a hole. They put the seed in. They covered it up and they watered it, and then, for a very long time, nothing happened at all.

Pip checked it every single day.

After nine days there was a green loop pushing out of the soil, like somebody underneath was trying to get out.

After three weeks there were leaves the size of her hand.

After a month there were leaves the size of her head, and a yellow flower, and Pip was told very firmly not to pick it.

STOP AND ASK

What does the seed need to grow?

The flower went brown and fell off, and underneath it there was a small green ball.

The ball got bigger. And bigger. It went from green to orange. It got bigger than a football, and then bigger than Pip's dog, and in the end it was so big that Pip and her grandad had to roll it into a wheelbarrow together.

One seed. The size of her thumbnail.

STOP AND ASK

What would you do with a pumpkin that big?



Talking About the Story

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

Five minutes on the carpet, then send them to tables for the drawing page. Kindergarten comprehension is spoken, not written, so this is where you find out whether the story landed.

Turn and talk, twice

SAY THIS

Turn to the person next to you. Tell them the part you liked best. I will count to twenty and then I want to hear two of them.

Now tell them one thing that happened at the beginning, and one thing that happened at the end.

What to listen for

DOING WELL	NOT YET
Retells one thing that actually happened in the story	Retells a different story, or tells you their own news
Uses a character name	Says "the one" or "him" for everybody
Answers the question that was asked	Answers a question nobody asked, which is very normal at five

The answers you are listening for

WHAT A GOOD ANSWER SOUNDS LIKE	
Question 1	Open. Let them be ridiculous. The story is going to beat most of their guesses anyway.
Question 2	Water, soil, sun, time. Take all four if they come, and supply time if nobody does.
Question 3	Open, and this is the fun one. Take five.

THEN SEND THEM TO TABLES

The drawing page comes next. Say it before you move: "Draw the part you liked best. One picture. You do not have to write anything."

A child who draws something not in the story has still listened. Ask them about it before you decide otherwise.

Teaching Pp

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD

SAY THIS

Today our sound is Pp. Watch my mouth. p.

Now you. p. Again, longer. p.

Put your hand in front of your mouth and say it again. Can you feel it?

Now I am going to say some words. Put your thumb up if the word starts with p.

Then, in this order

WHAT YOU DO

- 1 Write the letter big on the board, capital and small. Say the sound each time, not the letter name.
- 2 Say the words on the student page out loud, one at a time. Thumbs up or thumbs down.
- 3 Hand out the page. Point at the tracing rail and trace one in the air together first.
- 4 They trace, then circle the pictures. Say the picture names out loud as they work, because some will not know them.

THE SOUND, NOT THE NAME

Say p, not the letter name. At this age the sound is what lets them read; the name comes later and gets in the way now.

If a child is stuck

THEY CANNOT	DO THIS
Hear the sound	Say the word slowly and stretch the first sound. Stretch it far longer than feels sensible.
Form the letter	Trace it on their back with your finger, then let them trace it on the table, then on paper.
Name the picture	Tell them. It is a vocabulary gap, not a phonics one, and guessing wastes the block.



Teaching More and Fewer

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD

SAY THIS

Look at my hands. This hand has three counters and this hand has five. Which hand has more?

How do you know? Do not just look. Count them with me.

More means a bigger number of things. Fewer means a smaller number of things.

Now the tricky one. Spread three counters far apart, bunch five close together, and ask again which has more.

The thing you are actually teaching

SPREAD OUT DOES NOT MEAN MORE

This is the whole block. A young child judges more by how much space a group takes up, not how many things are in it. Spread three out, bunch five together, and ask. When they say the three, count them together. That moment is the lesson.

What good looks like

DOING WELL	NOT YET
Counts both groups before answering	Answers from how the groups look
Says which has more and which has fewer	Only has the word more
Is not fooled when a group is spread out	Picks the spread out group, which is normal at five

TWO PAGES, IN ORDER

The first math page is done together, out loud. The second is theirs to do at the table. If the block is running long, stop after the first page. Half of it done properly is worth more than both rushed.

Science: Where Our Food Comes From

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD TOGETHER

Read one numbered part at a time. Ask the question at the end of each one before you move on. This is a talking block, not a writing block.

1. Nearly everything we eat comes from a plant or an animal. Almost nothing we eat is made in a factory out of nothing.

Ask: name one thing you ate today. Where do you think it came from?

2. An apple grows on a tree. A pumpkin grows on a vine along the ground. A carrot grows under the soil, where you cannot see it at all.

Ask: how would you know when a carrot was ready?

3. Every one of those started as a seed, and a seed needs soil, water, sunlight and time. Take away any one of them and nothing happens.

Ask: which one do you think was hardest for Pip to give it?

4. Some things we use never grew at all. A cup. A ball. A spoon. Those were made, not grown.

Ask: is a wooden spoon grown or made? That one is worth arguing about.

THEN THE CUT AND SORT

Hand out the sorting page. Cut first, all of them, before anybody glues anything. Then sort. Then glue.

Grows: the apple and the carrot. Does not grow: the ball and the cup. Ask where the carrot grew. Under the ground is the answer most classes do not have yet.

What to Look For

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

Kindergarten work does not mark like older work. Most of these pages have no right answer, so this page tells you what to look at instead, and what to write on the note back.

The pages with actual answers

PAGE	ANSWER
Letters: Pp	Circle: pumpkin, pencil, pig, plant. Not circled: cat, moon, tree, fish.
Math: shapes	Row one: five has more. Row two: six has more. Row three: seven has more. On the second page look for exactly one extra circle.
Afternoon sort	Grows: the apple and the carrot. Does not grow: the ball and the cup. Ask where the carrot grew. Under the ground is the answer most classes do not have yet.

The pages with no right answer

PAGE	WHAT YOU ARE LOOKING AT
Morning work	Did they find their name line and have a go? Tracing quality is not the point on a day with a stranger in the room.
After the story	Does the picture come from the story? Ask them about it before deciding it does not.
Writing	One letter is a success. The initial sound is a big success. A whole word is a bonus, not the target.
How Was Today?	The most useful page in the pile. Read these first and leave them on top.

DO NOT CORRECT THE LETTER FORMATION

Backwards letters are developmentally normal at five and stay normal for a while yet. Correcting them in front of a substitute teaches a child that writing is dangerous. Leave it for the class teacher.

IF A CHILD PRODUCED NOTHING AT ALL

Do not push. Write their name on the sheet, note one line on the substitute page at the back, and move on. A child who freezes with a stranger in the room is telling you something, and it is not about the task.

Morning Work

Name: _____

1 Write your name at the top.

2 Trace the words. Say each one out loud.

3 Color the picture.

1. Trace and say

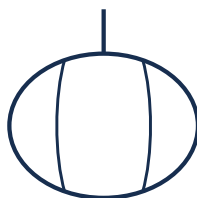
pot

pan

pin

2. Color me

COLOR THE PICTURE FROM TODAY'S STORY



After the Story

1 Draw the part you liked best.

2 Tell somebody about your picture.

DRAW YOUR FAVORITE PART



My picture

TALK ABOUT IT

Tell the person next to you what is happening in your picture.

Letter of the Day: Pp

1 Trace the letters.

2 Circle the pictures that start with the sound.

P p P p P p

Circle the ones that start with p



pumpkin



cat



pencil



moon



pig



tree



plant



fish

FINISHED?

Find one more thing in this room that starts with p. Draw it on the back of your sheet.

Draw and Label

1 Draw one thing from the story.

2 Write the first letter underneath.

YOUR PICTURE



What did you draw?

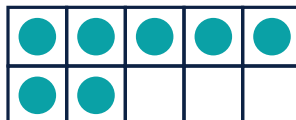
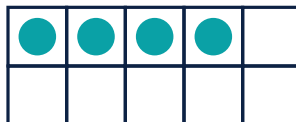
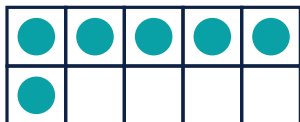
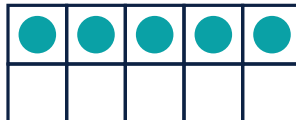
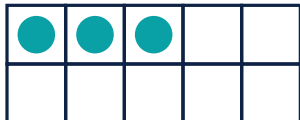
FOR THE SUBSTITUTE

One letter is a success here. If a child writes the first sound of their word, that is exactly where kindergarten writing should be. Do not ask for more, and do not correct what they do write.

More and Fewer

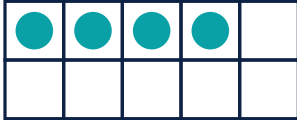
1 Count both rows out loud.

2 Circle the row that has more.



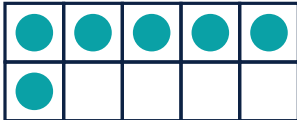
Your Turn

1 Count the circles in the first box.

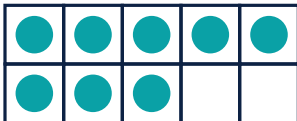


ONE MORE

2 Draw one more in the second box.



ONE MORE



ONE MORE



Where Our Food Comes From: Cut and Sort

1 Cut out the four pictures at the bottom.

2 Put each one in the right box.

3 Glue them down when you are sure.

GROWS ON A PLANT

DOES NOT GROW



apple



carrot



ball



cup

FINISHED?

Draw one more thing that would go in either box.

How Was Today?

1 Color the face that shows how today felt.

2 Draw one thing you did today.



Great day



Good day



Tricky day

One thing I did today

DRAW IT HERE



My name

Time Filler Bank

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE. YOU WILL NEED IT.

WHY THIS PAGE EXISTS

A kindergarten day is mostly gaps: five minutes before a special, ten because lunch ran late, the eternity while twenty five year olds put their coats on. Those gaps are where a class you do not know falls apart. Nothing below needs any equipment at all.

Under three minutes

ACTIVITY	HOW IT WORKS
Simon says	Never fails at this age. Speed it up to make it harder. You can play it in a line waiting for the bell.
Copy my clap	You clap a rhythm, they clap it back. Make it longer each time. Doubles as your quiet signal.
Head, shoulders, knees	Sing it. Then faster. Then missing out one body part.
Sleeping bunnies	Everybody curls up asleep. You wake them one table at a time. Buys you a genuinely calm two minutes.
I spy with sounds	Use the first sound, not the letter name. "I spy something starting with mmm." That makes it phonics.
Five finger counting	Hold up fingers, they call the number. Then you call, they hold up.

Three to ten minutes

ACTIVITY	HOW IT WORKS
The rhyming game	You say a word, they add rhymes around the circle. Made-up words are allowed and make it funnier.
What is missing?	Put four things on a table. They close their eyes. Take one away. What has gone?
Story chain	You start with one sentence. Each child adds one. Absurd is fine and usually better.
Guess my animal	You think of one. They ask yes or no questions. Cap it at ten and count them out loud.
Number of the day	Pick a number under ten. They say everything they know about it: one more, one less, on fingers.
Freeze dance, no music	You clap a beat, they move. You stop, they freeze. Needs nothing.

TWO RULES FOR ANY OF THESE

Say how it ends before it starts, and do not offer a choice. Pick one, announce it, run it. Asking twenty five year olds what they would like to play turns a calm five minutes into a difficult fifteen.

Brain Breaks and Transitions

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

USE ONE EVERY FIFTEEN MINUTES, NOT WHEN IT GOES WRONG

A five year old concentrates for about five to ten minutes on one thing. A break every fifteen minutes is not lost time. It is what buys you the next fifteen.

Signs you needed one five minutes ago: chairs tipping, three bathroom requests in a row, or the same question asked twice.

At their tables, one minute

BREAK	WHAT TO DO
Ten and ten	Ten shoulder rolls back, ten forward. Everyone stays seated.
Sky and toes	Reach to the sky for five, touch your toes for five. Three times.
Five big breaths	In through the nose for four, out through the mouth for six. Genuinely calms a room before writing.
Cross-body taps	Right hand to left knee, left hand to right knee, twenty times. Crossing the midline really does help.
Finger stretches	Spread, squeeze, spread, squeeze. Do it before every writing block, not after.

Standing up, two to three minutes

BREAK	WHAT TO DO
Animal moves	Hop like a frog, stretch like a cat, stomp like an elephant. Ten seconds each. They will suggest more.
Four corners	Name the corners one to four. Call a number, everyone moves. Call them faster.
Popcorn	Everybody crouches. You call names and each child pops up and back down. Speed up.
Follow the leader	You lead a march around the room and back to the carpet. Excellent for moving a class without a queue.
Shake it out	Shake one hand for eight, other hand for eight, one foot, other foot. Then four, then two, then one.

GETTING THEM BACK

Always say how it ends before it starts. "When I clap twice we are sitting down ready." A break without a stated ending is just noise you now have to fix.

Wet Weather Bank

SUBSTITUTE • FOR THE DAY IT RAINS

INDOOR RECESS IS THE HARDEST PART OF A KINDERGARTEN COVER DAY

They expect free time, you do not know the rules, and the room is not built for it. Pick one activity, announce it clearly, and run it for the whole period. Offering choices is what turns wet play into chaos.

Whole class, no equipment

GAME	HOW IT WORKS
Sleeping lions	Everyone lies still. You walk around. Anyone who moves or giggles sits up and helps you spot the others. Buys you fifteen quiet minutes and they never tire of it.
Heads down, thumbs up	Four children are chosen. Everyone else puts heads down, thumb up. The four each press one thumb.
The copying game	One child leaves. The class picks a leader who starts actions everyone copies. The detective works out who.
Corners	Number the corners. Call a number. Anyone in that corner sits down. Last standing wins.
Musical statues, no music	You clap, they dance. You stop, they freeze. Out means helping you spot the next one.

At tables, quieter

- Draw your bedroom from above, looking down. Harder and more absorbing than it sounds.
- Roll and draw. No dice? They pick a number one to six and you call one out. Each number is a body part to add to a monster.
- Name that pattern. Draw a repeating pattern on the board and they copy it and continue it.
- Partner drawing. One child draws a shape, the partner turns it into a picture.

TWO RULES TO STATE AT THE START

Everyone stays in the room, and when you clap the game stops instantly. Say both before you start, not after something goes wrong.

Choosing Time Menu

COPY THIS PAGE FOR CHILDREN, OR READ IT OUT

1 Pick any box.

2 You do not need to ask.

TRY THIS

- 1 Draw your favorite animal. Give it a name.
- 2 Draw a picture of the story we read today. Put yourself in it.
- 3 Find five things in the room that are round. Draw them.
- 4 Count how many chairs are in the room. Count again to check.
- 5 Write your name as big as the whole page.
- 6 Draw a machine that would tidy your bedroom for you.
- 7 Draw what you will do after school.
- 8 Draw something you are good at.

SPACE TO WORK

STILL FINISHED?

Look at a book quietly, or help someone at your table. Helping means asking them a question, not doing it for them.

Substitute's Note Back

SUBSTITUTE • FILL THIS IN BEFORE YOU LEAVE

THREE THINGS, THEN YOU ARE DONE

1. Stack the day's work on the desk with the How Was Today? sheets on top.
2. Name two or three children who genuinely helped. Teachers act on this and the children find out.
3. Write one line about anything the teacher should know. One line.

NOTE BACK TO THE TEACHER

My name

Day taught

Day 4 / Day 5 / Day 6

We got through

All of it / Most of it / The morning only

What we did not reach

Children who helped

Anyone upset or unwell

Toileting or clothes

The line the teacher most needs

Anything else

One line is plenty

Would I come back?

Yes, gladly / Yes / Probably not, because:

A NOTE TO THE RETURNING TEACHER

The most useful thing in the pile is not the worksheets. It is the stack of How Was Today? sheets, where each child has colored a face and drawn one thing they did. Read those first. They take four minutes and they will tell you more about the day than any of the work.

Standards Alignment

COMMON CORE AND NGSS • KINDERGARTEN

Each block is mapped to its primary standard. These are complete instructional days, not curriculum coverage, and every day stands alone.

DAY	BLOCK	FOCUS	STANDARD
1	Read aloud	Listening, prediction, retell	RL.K.1, RL.K.2, SL.K.2
1	Letters	Initial sound Ss, letter formation	RF.K.1.d, RF.K.3.a, L.K.1.a
1	Writing	Draw and label with an initial sound	W.K.2, L.K.2.c
1	Math	Counting to five, one to one correspondence	K.CC.B.4, K.CC.B.5
1	Science	How animals move	K-LS1-1
2	Read aloud	Problem and solution, character	RL.K.1, RL.K.3, SL.K.2
2	Letters	Initial sound Mm, letter formation	RF.K.1.d, RF.K.3.a
2	Writing	Draw and label with an initial sound	W.K.2
2	Math	Identifying and describing 2D shapes	K.G.A.2, K.G.B.4
2	Science	Day and night, patterns in the sky	K-ESS2-1
3	Read aloud	Counting within a story, cause and effect	RL.K.1, SL.K.1
3	Letters	Initial sound Tt, letter formation	RF.K.1.d, RF.K.3.a
3	Writing	Draw and label with an initial sound	W.K.2
3	Math	Counting to ten, writing numerals	K.CC.A.3, K.CC.B.4, K.CC.B.5
3	Science	What living things need	K-LS1-1, K-ESS3-1

Also practiced every day

- Letter formation, through the tracing rails on every morning and letters page
- Counting and number recognition, through the ten frames
- Speaking and listening, through the carpet discussion and turn and talk prompts
- Self-assessment, through the How Was Today? sheet

A NOTE ON STANDARDS

These are designed to be genuinely useful on a day the regular teacher is absent, without depending on where a class has reached in its own program.

This resource is independently created and is not affiliated with, endorsed by, or reviewed by any state agency or standards body.

Terms of Use and Credits

THANK YOU

Thank you for buying this pack. It was written by a practicing teacher with more than twenty years in classrooms, and built the way I would want a full day of kindergarten cover built if I were the one waking up sick at half past five.

If it saved you a morning, a rating genuinely helps other teachers find it, and earns you credit toward your next purchase.

Getting the most out of this pack

- Print all three days before you need them. The whole point is that it works on a morning when you cannot get to school.
- Copy each day as one stapled packet. Eight student pages. Handing out separate sheets all day is where a kindergarten class comes apart.
- Keep the eight substitute pages in order on the desk.
- Fill in the Class Information page once, at the start of the year.
- Use the filler banks when you are present too. The brain breaks work on any Tuesday.

Terms of use

You may: print this pack for your own classroom, as many times as you like, for as many years as you like. Photocopy the student pages freely for your own children and leave the pack for a substitute covering your own class.

You may not: share the file with colleagues, upload it to a school drive, district server, or any public website, resell it, or claim it as your own work. Additional licenses for colleagues are available at a discount on the listing page.

All stories, tasks, questions and answer keys in this pack are original works written for this resource and are copyright of the author. No third-party copyrighted material is reproduced anywhere in this pack.

ALSO FROM DIGITAL VECTOR

Full-Day Sub Plans, Kindergarten, Volume 1. Days 1 to 3, same build, three different stories.

Full-Day Sub Plans, Grades 3-5, Volumes 1 and 2. Six complete days for older elementary classes.

Emergency Sub Plans for Middle School Science, Math, ELA and Computer Science.

Credits

Written, designed and typeset by Clarence Goh. Set in Lato and JetBrains Mono.

Digital Vector • digitalvector.com.au

© Clarence Goh / Digital Vector. All rights reserved.